

System Access Control Policy

Meridian Global Corp — Confidential Internal Document

****System Access Control Policy****

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****Approved By:** Chief Information Security Officer (CISO), Meridian Global Corp.**

****1.0 Purpose and Scope****

This System Access Control Policy establishes the mandatory requirements for granting, managing, and revoking access to Meridian Global Corp's information systems, applications, networks, and data. The purpose is to ensure the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of corporate resources by controlling user access based on the principle of least privilege and need-to-know. This policy applies to all Meridian Global Corp employees, contractors, temporary staff, vendors, and any third-party individuals requiring access to company systems, regardless of their location or the device used for access.

****2.0 General Principles****

Access to Meridian Global Corp resources is granted solely to individuals with a legitimate business requirement. Access levels will be limited to the minimum necessary for the individual to perform their assigned duties (least privilege). All access is subject to continuous monitoring and periodic review.

User Account Provisioning

New user accounts and modifications to existing access privileges for corporate systems and applications require formal authorization and adherence to the following procedures:

1. ****Authorization:**** All requests for new accounts or changes to access privileges must be initiated by the user's direct manager or a designated department head. This authorization signifies the business need for the requested access.
2. ****IT Service Ticket:**** Following managerial approval, a formal service request must be submitted to the IT Service Desk via the Meridian Global Corp IT portal. The ticket must clearly specify the user, requested systems/applications, and the approved access level.
3. ****Provisioning Timeframe:**** Upon receipt of a properly authorized and documented IT service ticket, the IT Department is mandated to provision the requested access within

twenty-four (24) business hours. Exceptions for critical business continuity scenarios must be approved by IT management.

Password Requirements

All user accounts for Meridian Global Corp corporate systems must adhere to strict password standards to protect against unauthorized access:

1. **Minimum Length:** Passwords must be a minimum of twelve (12) characters in length.
2. **Complexity:** Passwords must include a combination of characters from at least three (3) of the following four (4) categories:
 - * Uppercase English letters (A-Z)
 - * Lowercase English letters (a-z)
 - * Numbers (0-9)
 - * Non-alphanumeric symbols (e.g., !, @, #, \$, %, ^, &, *)
3. **Prohibition of Reuse:** Users are prohibited from reusing any of their previous twelve (12) passwords.
4. **Confidentiality:** Passwords must never be shared, written down in an insecure location, or stored unencrypted.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

To enhance the security of user authentication, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all access to Meridian Global Corp corporate systems and applications. This requirement became effective universally on January 1, 2025. All employees, contractors, and third parties accessing corporate resources must register and utilize an approved MFA method, such as a mobile authenticator app or hardware token, as directed by the IT Department.

Privileged Access Management

Access to systems and data classified as "privileged" (e.g., administrative accounts, root access, financial system administrators, HR system administrators) is subject to heightened scrutiny and control:

1. **Justification:** Granting of privileged access requires explicit approval from the relevant system owner and the Information Security Team, based on a documented business need.
2. **Regular Reviews:** All privileged access assignments must undergo a formal review process every ninety (90) days. During this review, the system owner and the user's

manager must re-validate the continued necessity and appropriateness of the privileged access. Unjustified or unused privileged access must be immediately revoked.

3. ****Separation of Duties:**** Where feasible, duties requiring privileged access must be separated to prevent a single individual from having end-to-end control over critical processes.

Remote Access Control

Any access to Meridian Global Corp's corporate network and systems from outside the corporate network perimeter (e.g., from home, public Wi-Fi, client sites) must exclusively utilize the corporate Virtual Private Network (VPN) solution.

1. ****VPN Requirement:**** The Meridian Global Corp VPN client must be installed and active on all devices used for remote access to corporate resources.

2. ****Approved Devices:**** Remote access is only permitted from corporate-owned and managed devices, unless explicitly approved by the IT Department for specific, temporary circumstances involving personal devices, which must still comply with all security policies.

Access Revocation and Offboarding

Prompt and complete revocation of access is critical upon an individual's departure or change in role.

1. ****HR Notification:**** The Human Resources (HR) Department is responsible for notifying the IT Department of an employee's or contractor's last working day or internal transfer, with at least 24 hours' notice.

2. ****Revocation Timeframe:**** All system and network access for departing employees or contractors must be fully revoked within four (4) hours of their officially recorded last working day. For internal transfers, access must be adjusted to the new role's requirements within the same timeframe, with previous role-specific access revoked.

3. ****Account Disable/Deletion:**** User accounts will be disabled immediately upon revocation and formally deleted from relevant systems in accordance with Meridian Global Corp's data retention policies.

Account Management and Prohibitions

1. ****Prohibition of Shared Accounts:**** The use of shared or generic accounts (e.g., "guest," "admin@department") is strictly prohibited for individual access to corporate systems, except for service accounts specifically designed for automated processes and managed under strict controls by the IT Department. Each individual must have a unique, identifiable user account.

2. **Contractor Account Expiration:** Accounts provisioned for contractors, consultants, and temporary staff will be configured to automatically expire after ninety (90) days from their creation date, or earlier based on the contract end date. Extensions beyond 90 days require formal re-authorization by the sponsoring manager and the submission of a new IT service ticket.

3. **Account Ownership:** Every user account must be assigned to an identifiable individual who is solely responsible for its proper use and security.

Policy Enforcement and Compliance

Failure to comply with this System Access Control Policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract, and potential legal action. The Information Security Team will regularly audit access controls and user activities to ensure ongoing compliance. Any exceptions to this policy must be formally documented and approved by the CISO.